Survey Consent

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Study Title: Experts' evaluation of novelty of MV and LV DC technologies/solutions proposals.

Context: The objective of this study is to gather perspectives on the novelty of five (5) MV/LV DC technologies proposals (hereafter referred to as DC solutions). The presented DC solutions are considered novel and applicable to the core demonstration sites of the Shift2DC project (i.e., ports, buildings, data centers, and industry). For this survey, *'novel'* refers to originality relative to current practice and the state of the art in DC solutions. To ensure a balanced evaluation, additional study information will be shared later.

Study explanation: This study collects perspectives on five (5) DC solutions from experts with DC backgrounds through an online questionnaire. Participation is fully remote. After submitting your consent, you will receive a link to access the questionnaire via email. You will then complete and submit it online; no in-person meeting is required. The questionnaire is expected to take approximately 15 minutes to complete.

Conditions and funding: Participation in the study does not involve compensation for the participating experts. We appreciate your contribution to the scientific community and look forward to sharing the results upon publication. There is no identifiable risk of participation in the study. This study has received a favorable opinion from the University of Madeira's data protection office and ethics committee.

Anonymity and confidentiality: This study collects email addresses solely to share the questionnaire link, and discards them thereafter; during storage, we will use form IDs and will not link them to an identifiable person when reporting study results. Responses are recorded anonymously and stored on secure, password-protected servers accessible only to the research team. Results will be reported only in aggregated form in academic publications; if quotations are used, they will be presented without any link to an identifiable person or organization. Please read this information carefully. If you find anything incorrect or unclear, or require further information at any time, please do not hesitate to contact the research team using the contact details provided in this form.

1. Email address *

Please enter an email

2. I declare that I have read, understood, and agree to the terms of this document as shared by the investigating researchers. I have been guaranteed the right to refuse to participate in this study at any time, without any consequences. Therefore, I agree to participate in this study and allow the use of the data I voluntarily provide, trusting that it will be used solely for scientific purposes and publications arising therefrom, with the guarantees of confidentiality and anonymity provided to me by the researcher. *

- ◯ I give consent to participate

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